BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
AIR COMBAT COMMAND

AIR COMBAT COMMAND MISSION DIRECTIVE 053

14 AUGUST 2025

Mission Directive

53D WING

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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This mission directive implements guidance in AFI 38-101, *Manpower and Organization*. Its purpose is to prescribe unit mission, command relationship, and responsibilities of the 53d Wing (53 WG). This mission directive applies to 53 WG and subordinate Regular Air Force units and assigned civilian personnel. It does not apply to Air Force Reserve Command, Air National Guard, or United States Space Force units. Test and Evaluation guidance is derived by DoDI 5000.89_DAFI99-103, *Capabilities-Based Test and Evaluation*. Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained IAW AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of IAW the Air Force Records Information Management System Records Disposition Schedule. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*; route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. Air Combat Command Director of Plans, Programs, and Requirements (ACC A5/8/9) is the waiver authority for compliance items in this publication. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the publication OPR for consideration. This publication may not be supplemented or further implemented/extended.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

The command relationship has been updated in this rewrite.

1. Mission. The 53 WG provides tactical advantage to the warfighter at the speed of relevance by operationally testing and evaluating new equipment, software, weapons, and other capabilities, evaluating currently fielded capabilities through the Weapons System Evaluation Program (WSEP) and by optimizing the USAF's combat capabilities through integration and tactics development to conduct joint, all-domain combat operations. The 53 WG serves as the higher headquarters for three groups: 53d Test and Evaluation Group (53 TEG); 753 Test and Evaluations Group (753 TEG); and 53d Weapons Evaluation Group (53 WEG).

2. Command.

2.1. The 53 WG is organized under the USAF Warfare Center (USAFWC). ACC A5/8/9 provides oversight for ACC, the USAFWC, and 53 WG Operations, Training, and Evaluation (OT&E) processes.

2.2. The 53 WG establishes and maintains collaborative relationships with joint, interagency, ally, and partner organizations tasked to develop, test, field, and prepare forces to employ advanced warfighting capabilities. The 53 WG is direct liaison authorized (DIRLAUTH) to consult or coordinate with organizations outside the chain of command to align priorities across test and evaluation, tactics development, integration, and weapons system evaluation programs. This authority is granted to shape and influence operational and tactical warfighting efforts through the development, refinement, and integration of the USAF's most advanced capabilities, synchronizing future concepts and emerging technologies.

3. Responsibilities.

3.1. The 53 WG/CC reports to USAFWC/CC and conducts its assigned missions by, with, and through the following MAJCOMS, Centers, and Offices: ACC, AFGSC, AFMC, Air Force Operational Test and Evaluation Center (AFOTEC), F-35 United States Operational Test Team (UOTT), and the Rapid Capabilities Office (RCO). Additionally, the 53 WG supports forward-based combat air forces assigned to Air Force Components: AFCENT, AFSOUTH, PACAF, and USAFE.

3.2. Plan, manage, execute and support operational test and evaluation activities as directed by ACC. Specifically, the 53 WG is manned, equipped, and funded to command, organize, manage, supervise, and inspect the 53 WG.

3.3. Responsible for mission execution, discipline, morale, and welfare of assigned personnel.

3.4. Lead the planning, execution, and reporting of operational assessments, tests, and evaluations for HHQ and MAJCOM-assigned tests and evaluate the overall effectiveness and suitability of new and fielded weapons systems to meet current and emerging warfighter needs.

3.5. Conduct the Combat Air Forces (CAT) Foreign Materiel Exploitation evaluations.

3.6. Plan, execute, and develop joint integrated Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures at the operational and tactical level of war.

3.7. Conduct evaluations in accordance with CSAF PLAN 53: *Weapons System Evaluation Program,* for air-to-air weapons, air-to-ground weapons, battle management command and control, synthetic environment, and conventional air-launched cruise missiles.

3.8. Conduct activities as directed in COMACC Plan 21: *Large Force Test Event, BLACK FLAG.*

3.9. Support evaluations in accordance with AFGSC/CC Plan 001: *Nuclear Weapons System Evaluation Plan.*

3.10. Respond to Combatant Commanders' Urgent Operational Need requests. Plan and execute OT&E and develop joint integrated operational testing in response to urgent warfighter needs.

3.11. Support Air Force and joint warfighters in the formulation, development, demonstration and assessment of concepts, doctrines, mission needs, and requirements for the fielding of new capabilities, such as Advanced Concept Technology Demonstrations.

ADRIAN L. SPAIN
General, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

AFI 38-101, *Manpower and Organization*, 29 August 2019

DoDI 5000.89_DAFI99-103, *Capabilities-Based Test and Evaluation*, 9 December 2021

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

53 TEG—53d Test and Evaluation Group

53 WEG—53d Weapons Evaluation Group

53 WG/CC—Commander, 53d Wing

753 TEG—753 Test and Evaluation Group

AFOTEC—Air Force Operational Test and Evaluation Center

CAF—Combat Air Forces

COMACC—Commander, Air Combat Command

CSAF—Chief of Staff of the Air Force

DIRLAUTH—Direct Liaison Authorized

JOTT—Joint Strike Fighter Operational Test Team

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

OT&E—Operational Test and Evaluation

RCO—Regional Contracting Office

UOTT—United States Operational Test Team

USAFWC—United States Air Force Warfare Center

WSEP—Weapon System Evaluation Program

Office Symbols

AFGSC/CC—Commander, Air Force Global Strike Command

ACC/A5/8/9—Air Combat Command Directorate of Plans, Programs, and Requirements